

2b. Content of A Level Art and Design (H600-H606)

Component 01: Personal investigation

This component comprises two discrete but linked elements.

Element 1: Practical portfolio

This is a practical portfolio with supporting contextual research in which learners are expected to develop a personal response based on the centre-set or learner-set theme leading to a finished realisation(s) or outcome(s).

This portfolio will consist of a sustained project, theme or course of study. It may be presented in appropriate formats for the specialism and area of study chosen using, for example, sketchbooks, mounted sheets, maquettes, prototypes, digital presentations, animation, scale models or illustrated written work.

There is no restriction on the scale of work produced or the timeframe for undertaking the work but learners should carefully **select**, **organise** and **present** work to ensure that they provide evidence of meeting all four assessment objectives.

Learners must show they have:

- independently developed ideas through sustained and focused investigations in response to a given starting point
- produced material informed by contextual and other sources that informs the development of their practical work

- explored ideas, techniques or processes appropriate to their chosen specialism(s)
- recorded observations from sources relevant to intentions
- critically reviewed and refined their work as it progresses
- used their planning and preparation to produce coherent realisation(s)/outcome(s).

For the purposes of assessment, learners will provide evidence of all the assessment objectives through the **careful selection and presentation** of their work. The practical portfolio should be viewed as a whole and judgements regarding the extent to which all of the assessment objectives have been met should be made across the submission as a whole.

OCR-produced exemplar material is provided to help centres design and set their own starting points, briefs, scenarios and stimuli but this material must not be used for summative assessment. This is available on the [OCR website](#).

Element 2: Related study

Learners are required to establish through this written and, where appropriate, illustrated component, the related context in which their chosen practical portfolio exists.

This may be established by exploring the genre, subject matter, movement or historical framework of the overarching starting point, course of study or theme selected.

The aim of the related study is to enable learners to develop their ability to communicate their knowledge and understanding of art historical movements, genres, practitioners and artworks, considering the way that these change and evolve within chronological and other frameworks. It also builds their understanding of the relationship between society and art: art historical terms, concepts and issues; methods of researching, investigating and analysing; and how works are interpreted and evaluated.

The related study should be separate and clearly identifiable from the contextual research embedded in the development of the practical portfolio. Learners should also highlight their own work and clearly distinguish it from collected or transposed material.

Learners may produce the related study in an appropriate form of which the following are some examples: an illustrated essay, digital presentation/blog, illustrated study sheets or written report.

It is a requirement of the related study that all source material and research are listed and acknowledged in a bibliography and should be clearly identifiable in the work presented for assessment.

The two elements of the Personal investigation are marked using the relevant sections of the Personal investigation Marking Criteria in Section 3e.

Component 02: Externally set task

For this component, an early release paper will be dispatched to centres based on estimated entries made and will also be available on the [OCR website](#) from 1 February.

This paper can be given to learners at the discretion of centres any time on or after 1 February in the year of certification. Centres

Realising intentions

Learners will have up to fifteen hours in which to independently realise their response(s). The fifteen-hour supervised time can be divided into a number of sessions and timetabled to suit the centre. Centres should ensure that short sessions are avoided.